Worked for 33s

Yes. Before we go back into the Prologue scene-by-scene, we should lock the **physical Phantom Q Headquarters map and the character system** because everything else must happen inside this same world.

The important point is: **we are not designing a new map now.** We are formalising the Headquarters structure we already agreed on so that the campaign, slides, 3D environment and eventual game development all use the same spatial source of truth.

1. Phantom Q Headquarters — Canonical Map

The agreed world is:

- **one persistent Phantom Q Headquarters**;
- primarily **one main level** for Release 1;
- **central hub with short wings**, not a maze;
- raised-oblique / 2.5D view at roughly **55–65° downward**;
- fixed world orientation;
- Sims-style cutaway walls so the player can see inside rooms;
- rooms are actual locations, **not menu buttons**;
- the learner physically moves between areas;
- doors/access readers visibly communicate clearance;
- movement, location, time and authorisation can later become evidence;
- the same map is used throughout the campaign.

That means:

```
PLAYER DOES NOT:

Incident 01 → load random classroom
Incident 02 → load unrelated crypto world
Incident 03 → another environment
Incident 04 → another environment


PLAYER DOES:

PHANTOM Q HEADQUARTERS
        ↓
moves through the same building
        ↓
new areas unlock as capability increases
```

2. Agreed High-Level Spatial Arrangement

The previously agreed canonical spatial logic was approximately:

```
                    ┌──────────────────────────────────┐
                    │     TRAINING / FOUNDATIONS       │
                    │                                  │
                    │  CRYPTOGRAPHY   COMMUNICATIONS   │
                    └────────────┬─────────────────────┘
                                 │
             ┌───────────────────┼───────────────────┐
             │                   │                   │
        RED TEAM        CENTRAL OPERATIONS          SOC
             │                   │                   │
             └───────────────────┼───────────────────┘
                                 │
                        RECEPTION / ID
                                 │
                             ENTRANCE
                                 │
             ┌───────────────────┼───────────────────┐
             │                   │                   │
       ENGINEERING         QUANTUM WING       ADVANCED COMPUTE
                                 │
                                 ▼
                            SECURE CORE
                         HIGH RESTRICTION
```

This is the **functional arrangement**, not a completely new architectural drawing.

The key anchor remains:

CENTRAL OPERATIONS = HEART OF HQ

Everything important eventually connects back there.

---

3. Why Central Operations Must Be the Centre

Central Operations is where the campaign begins to feel connected.

It contains or interfaces with:

- Workstation 04;
- trainee operational desk;
- incident status;
- mission board;
- command messages;

- case progress;
- HQ status;
- security alerts;
- recovery status;
- later Red Team authorisation.

So in the world:

```
                        TRAINING
                           |
CRYPTO ────────── CENTRAL OPERATIONS ──────── SOC
                           |
                     RECEPTION / ID
```

Central Ops is not just another room.

It is the **narrative anchor**.

Every time something changes in the wider HQ, Central Operations can reflect it.

---

4. Entrance / Reception / ID

Function

This is the learner's first contact with Phantom Q.

It handles:

```
ARRIVAL
↓
REGISTRATION
↓
TRAINING IDENTITY
↓
ACCESS BADGE
↓
INITIAL CLEARANCE
```

Prologue usage

This is where:

- the trainee arrives;
- registration occurs;
- their fictional Phantom Q credential is created;
- Eve performs the authorised credential/security check;

- the player's initial clearance is established.

Visually:

```
ENTRANCE
   ↓
RECEPTION
   ↓
IDENTITY / BADGE STATION
   ↓
ACCESS GATE
   ↓
CENTRAL HQ
```

The player should immediately experience that **access is controlled**.

---

5. Central Operations

This becomes the player's operational home.

Important persistent object

WORKSTATION 04

It should physically remain the same workstation.

Not:

```
random computer per scene
```

but:

```
WORKSTATION 04

Prologue
↓
PQ-001
↓
later evidence
↓
status updates
↓
mission management
```

This continuity is important.

Prologue

Alice physically arrives here with the USB.

Bob exists remotely through the communications system.

Files:

```
01_LAYOUT.PNG
02_REPORT.PDF
03_ACCESS_SCHEDULE.XLSX
```

The first anomaly begins here.

Later incidents

Central Operations becomes the place where the player can see:

```
ACTIVE INCIDENT
CURRENT OBJECTIVE
CLEARANCE
UNLOCKED FACILITIES
EVIDENCE
MISSION STATUS
```

So after Incident 06 it should visibly feel different from when the trainee first arrived.

---

6. Training & Foundations

Initially locked.

After PQ-001:

```
CLEARANCE UPDATE

FOUNDATIONS
UNLOCKED
```

This becomes the physical home of **Incident 01**.

But it should not look like a school classroom.

It should be an operational training environment containing things such as:

```
EVIDENCE RECONSTRUCTION
FACT / ASSUMPTION
SOURCE / TRANSFER / RECEIVER
CIA ASSESSMENT
ALGORITHMIC REASONING
```

This is where the trainee learns to **think like a security engineer**.

---

7. Cryptography Laboratory

This becomes one of the most important recurring locations.

Used mainly for:

```
INCIDENT 02
Symmetric protection

INCIDENT 03
Operational symmetric link

INCIDENT 05
Asymmetric construction
```

So the laboratory itself evolves with the player.

Early Crypto Lab

The learner can work with:

```
PLAINTEXT
CIPHERTEXT
KEY A7
ENCRYPT
DECRYPT
```

Later Crypto Lab

Additional equipment/interfaces unlock:

```
PUBLIC KEY
PRIVATE KEY
DIGITAL SIGNATURE
```

```
TRUST REGISTER
SESSION KEY S1
```

The physical room remains the same.

The capability changes.

That is much better than constructing separate “symmetric room” and “asymmetric room”.

---

8. Communications Area

This needs to remain distinct from the Cryptography Lab.

Because:

> **Cryptography protects information. Communications represents the path over which it moves.**

That distinction becomes extremely important in Incidents 04 and 05.

The Communications area visually represents:

```
ALICE
      \
       NETWORK / CHANNEL
      /
BOB
```

and later:

```
HQ
      \
        NETWORK
      /
RED TEAM
```

It can display:

- source;
- destination;
- sessions;
- traffic;
- message delivery;
- timing;
- channel state;
- later IP information.

9. Security Operations Centre — SOC

The SOC is different from Central Operations.

Central Operations

Runs normal Phantom Q operations.

SOC

Investigates and responds when something goes wrong.

That means when PQ-001 begins:

```
NORMAL OPERATIONS
      ↓
INCIDENT CREATED
      ↓
SOC ACTIVE
```

The SOC becomes increasingly important from Incident 04 onwards.

It holds:

```
SESSION LOGS
INCIDENT TIMELINES
NETWORK EVIDENCE
EVENT CORRELATION
SECURITY MONITORING
CASE STATUS
```

By Incident 06, this becomes one of the major investigation spaces.

---

10. Red Team Operations

Initially:

```
LOCKED
```

The trainee should be able to **see that it exists long before being allowed to use it**.

That makes the progression meaningful.

Early door:

```
RED TEAM OPERATIONS

CLEARANCE REQUIRED
```

After the required capability has been demonstrated:

```
RED TEAM ACCESS
AVAILABLE
```

Incident 05 puts Red Team on standby.

Incident 06 finally activates the unit.

Red Team room should feel different

Not villainous.

It is still Phantom Q.

But more operational:

- network maps;
- target boards;
- controlled-access tools;
- attack-surface systems;
- evidence capture;
- monitoring;
- secure mission console.

The learner should feel:

> **I have progressed from trainee investigation into authorised security operations.**

---

11. Engineering Area

Engineering exists as part of the wider Phantom Q identity.

It should eventually support:

- hardware;
- embedded security;
- devices;
- network/physical integration;

- QKD hardware;
- diagnostics;
- system construction.

For the current Prologue–Incident 06 storyline it does **not need to dominate**.

But it must already exist on the map because Phantom Q Engineers is not merely a software cybersecurity organisation.

---

12. Quantum Wing

This remains part of the persistent HQ.

This is crucial for the wider game.

But we do not need to force it into every current Incident simply because the project involves QKD.

Initially:

```
QUANTUM WING

ACCESS RESTRICTED
```

The learner sees that a deeper level of technology exists.

That gives us room for later releases/Acts to expand:

```
CLASSICAL SECURITY
↓
QUANTUM THREAT
↓
QKD
↓
PHYSICAL QKD
```

without needing to redesign Headquarters.

---

13. Advanced Compute

Another restricted facility.

Used later for:

- advanced computation;
- quantum-threat simulation;
- more sophisticated security analysis;
- Prime Maze / quantum-compute concepts where appropriate;
- later campaign escalation.

Again:

```
VISIBLE
BUT NOT NECESSARILY ACCESSIBLE
```

early in the game.

---

14. Secure Core

This should be the deepest restricted area.

Not something the trainee can casually enter.

Conceptually:

```
PUBLIC / BASIC HQ
        ↓
OPERATIONAL AREAS
        ↓
SPECIALIST LABS
        ↓
ADVANCED COMPUTE / QUANTUM
        ↓
SECURE CORE
```

So the building itself communicates progression.

The player naturally asks:

> **What is behind that door?**

That is useful game design.

---

15. Clearance Is Part of the Map

Doors should communicate:

```
OPEN
RESTRICTED
LOCKED
MISSION AUTHORISED
```

For example:

Beginning

```
Reception              OPEN
Central Operations     LIMITED
Training               LOCKED
Crypto Lab             LOCKED
SOC                    RESTRICTED
Red Team               LOCKED
Quantum Wing           LOCKED
Secure Core            LOCKED
```

As the player develops:

```
SKILL
↓
PROVEN CAPABILITY
↓
CLEARANCE
↓
DOOR OPENS
```

This should be a visible game mechanic.

---

16. Campaign Movement Through HQ

Now the physical map aligns with the story.

```
PROLOGUE
Entrance
↓
Reception / ID
↓
Central Operations
↓
Workstation 04


INCIDENT 01
Central Operations
↓
```

Training / Foundations
↓
Central Operations

INCIDENT 02
Central Operations
↓
Cryptography Lab
↓
Communications

INCIDENT 03
Cryptography Lab
↔
Communications
↔
Bob Remote

INCIDENT 04
Central Operations
↓
Communications
↓
SOC
↓
Incident Investigation

INCIDENT 05
SOC
↓
Network Evidence
↓
Cryptography Lab
↓
Communications
↓
Red Team Standby

INCIDENT 06
SOC
↓
Red Team Operations
↓
HQ Command
↓
Target Investigation
↓

```
Recovery
↓
Central Operations
```

And finally:

```
RETURN TO HQ
↓
SERVICE RESTORED
```

So the campaign physically travels through the Headquarters.

---

17. Characters — Lock the Core Cast

Now the other thing we absolutely need to stabilise.

The Trainee / Player

Role

The player is:

> **a new Phantom Q trainee who progressively becomes a trusted Phantom Q Engineer.**

Do **not give the trainee a fixed invented name** unless the player's profile provides one.

The character is the player's avatar.

Beginning

```
ROLE
Trainee

CLEARANCE
Low

TOOLS
Basic

RESPONSIBILITY
Limited
```

End of Incident 06

```
ROLE
Phantom Q Engineer / proven trainee

CAPABILITIES
Investigation
Cryptography
Networking
Trust verification
Incident response
Controlled Red Team participation
Recovery
```

The visual character should remain recognisable throughout the whole game.

---

18. Alice

Persistent security perspective

Sender / Protector / Origin

Alice is not just:

> the woman who sends files.

She represents questions such as:

```
What was the original information?

Who created the instruction?

What should Bob have received?

How should information be protected?
```

Story role

Prologue

Physically brings the USB.

Incident 02

Owns the plaintext/source information.

Incident 03

Creates the legitimate payment instruction.

Incident 04

Provides the critical source-of-truth comparison:

```
ALICE ORIGINAL
R100 / 4821
```

She says:

> “Those aren't the details I gave you.”

That makes her role extremely important.

---

19. Bob

Persistent security perspective

Receiver / Verifier

Bob represents:

```
What did I receive?

Can I access it?

Can I decrypt it?

Does it match?

Can I trust where it came from?
```

Story role

Prologue

Remote receiver.

Incident 02

Receives ciphertext but lacks A7.

Incident 03

Receives A7, decrypts, verifies, processes R100.

Incident 04

Receives and decrypts the fraudulent instruction and sends R1 000.

This is important:

Bob is **not incompetent**.

The security model failed him.

That distinction must remain.

---

20. Eve

This one must be handled extremely carefully.

Persistent perspective

Security Support / Authorised Testing / Adversarial Thinking

Eve is **not automatically the villain**.

During Release 1:

```
EVE
Authorised Phantom Q security role

NOT
confirmed attacker
```

Prologue

She performs the credential/security check.

Later, when suspicious activity appears:

```
AUTHORISED EVE TEST
NONE ACTIVE
```

This means:

> Eve cannot explain the event.

It does **not** mean:

> Eve therefore did it.

Gameplay function

Eve can help the learner understand:

- what an observer could see;
- what an authorised security tester might check;
- channel exposure;
- adversarial thinking;
- attack-surface reasoning.

But her visuals must never suddenly become:

```
hooded hacker
red villain
evil pose
```

That would spoil the narrative.

---

21. Red Team

The Red Team is different from Eve.

Eve is a persistent security/adversarial-testing perspective.

Red Team is an **authorised operational unit**.

Initially:

```
RED TEAM
Restricted
```

Incident 05:

```
RED TEAM
Standby
```

Incident 06:

```
RED TEAM
DEPLOYED
```

Their job becomes:

```
TRACE
VALIDATE
REQUEST AUTHORITY
ENGAGE
COLLECT
CONTAIN
REPORT
```

They should visually look like professional Phantom Q personnel, not criminals.

---

22. Unknown Actor / Phantom

This should remain deliberately different from the other characters.

We do **not need a fully visible human model yet**.

That is important.

The unknown actor is represented through:

```
ANOMALY
↓
SESSION
↓
UNKNOWN KEY USE
↓
NETWORK TRAIL
↓
INFRASTRUCTURE
↓
RELAY
↓
ARTEFACTS
↓
POSSIBLE PHANTOM MARKER
```

The player experiences the actor through **effects and evidence**.

Not through cutscenes showing a hooded hacker pressing buttons.

That preserves mystery.

23. Character Knowledge Must Be Separate

This is extremely important for multiplayer.

At any moment:

```
ALICE KNOWS
her original information

BOB KNOWS
what he received

EVE KNOWS
her authorised test/security information

TRAINEE KNOWS
only what their role/clearance reveals

RED TEAM KNOWS
only what their operation provides
```

There must not be a magical shared omniscient screen.

This supports the previously agreed rule:

> **Capability may be universal; live information remains role-specific.**

---

24. Character Visual Lock

Once we establish the final models:

```
FACE
SKIN TONE
HAIR
HEIGHT
BODY PROPORTIONS
CLOTHING
SHOES
BADGE
ROLE MARKINGS
```

must remain the same.

No:

```
Alice changes ethnicity
Bob changes hairstyle
trainee changes gender between rooms
Eve changes costume and becomes a hacker
```

This was one of the major problems we saw during slide generation.

---

25. Art Direction

Characters should be:

> **realistic stylised 3D humans**

not:

- photorealistic humans;
- flat stock-photo cut-outs;
- anime;
- Among Us;
- extreme cartoon characters.

Think:

```
REALISTIC HUMAN PROPORTIONS
+
SIMPLIFIED FACES
+
CLEAN MATERIALS
+
GAME CHARACTER QUALITY
```

with natural South African diversity across the cast.

---

26. Persistent Character Relationships

The four core perspectives form:

```
                TRAINEE
             learns / acts
                   |
     ┌─────────────┼─────────────┐
     |             |             |
   ALICE          BOB           EVE
```

Later:

```
                 |
             RED TEAM
         Operational response
```

And outside all of them:

```
           UNKNOWN ACTOR
                ?
```

That is the correct character architecture.

---

27. Map + Character System Together

Now the game looks like this:

```
                        PHANTOM Q HQ
                             │
            ┌────────────────┼────────────────┐
            │                │                │
        TRAINING          CRYPTO         COMMUNICATIONS
            │                │                │
            └────────────────┼────────────────┘
                             │
        RED TEAM ───── CENTRAL OPS ───── SOC
                             │
                    WORKSTATION 04
                             │
                      RECEPTION / ID
                             │
                          ENTRANCE
                             │
        ENGINEERING ─ QUANTUM ─ ADV COMPUTE
                             │
                        SECURE CORE
```

Characters move **through this same environment** as the campaign advances.

---

28. What I Would Lock From This Map

Before we draw a proper detailed map, these should be treated as fixed:

1. **One persistent Headquarters.**

2. **Central Operations is the narrative hub.**
3. **Entrance → Reception/ID → Central HQ is the starting progression.**
4. **Training, Crypto, Communications, SOC and Red Team are real separate spaces.**
5. **Engineering, Quantum Wing, Advanced Compute and Secure Core already exist even when locked.**
6. **The map is compact: central hub + short wings, not a maze.**
7. **Doors and clearance are part of gameplay.**
8. **Workstation 04 is persistent.**
9. **Alice = Origin/Protector.**
10. **Bob = Receiver/Verifier.**
11. **Eve = authorised Security Support/Testing, not presumed attacker.**
12. **Red Team = authorised offensive/response unit.**
13. **Unknown actor remains unknown.**
14. **Character appearance remains persistent.**
15. **Information remains role-specific.**
16. **The learner physically sees previously locked areas become accessible as capability grows.**

This gives us the foundation to next map **the actual room-by-room Headquarters layout in greater detail — what each room contains, doors/access connections, interactable objects, NPC positions, and which incident activates which objects — without changing the canonical HQ structure.**